

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

LAURA LOOMER

Trump loyalist; American political activist

VOICE OF TRUMP'S AMERICA

Unapologetically Islamophobic, ardent Trump supporter and loyalty enforcer, and strongly anti-immigration, Laura Loomer did not disappoint at the India Today conclave. After a conciliatory opening gambit, where she relayed President Donald Trump's message declaring 'I love India, I love Modi, I love Indian people', she swiftly proceeded to outline how she has the president's ear and helps him weed out bad actors in the administration, even if she does not hold any position within the White House. "It allows me to not have to self-censor, deliver blows, be a little bit harsher and more direct, more blunt in my speech to enact change," she said.

Asked how the US president is so close to Pakistan if he wants to wage war on Islamic terror, Loomer said she was against the administration cosying up to Islamic nations, including Pakistan—"I've made it very clear (to the president) that I would prefer to not see Arab leaders, Islamic leaders in the Oval Office." But then, she said she was powerless to tell the President of the United States what to do.

Making common cause with India, which she said was forced to deal with the reality of Islamic jihad on a daily basis—"inhabited by over 204 million Muslims out of a population of 1.4 billion" people—she said the US, Israel and India form a strategic bulwark, a "trifecta of power" against Islamic terror.

Cornered on her anti-India posts on social media hashtagged 'Go Back to India', Loomer went on the defensive, saying what they opposed was H-1B visas. "How do you think young Americans feel," she asked, "when big tech companies tell them they're not the best and brightest, and they must import people from China and India?" ■

> **"Pakistan's biggest export to the world is Islamic terrorism. We should not be cosying up to its openly jihadist and pro-Sharia government**
>
> **I don't have hatred for India or Hindus; my comments come from a place of love for my people and country**

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **The American dream is not only white, Loomer said, but the US *is* a majority white Christian country, which does not want its culture to be eroded by others**
- **Loomer sees Islam, which she called a political ideology focused on eradicating non-Muslims, as the biggest threat**
- **The Trump doctrine, she said, is simple: hit terrorists hard, hit them first, build coalitions to choke off their lifelines**
- **American reach, Israeli asymmetrical warfare and India's demographic and economic might, she said, make them a perfect trifecta of power to take on Islamist terror**